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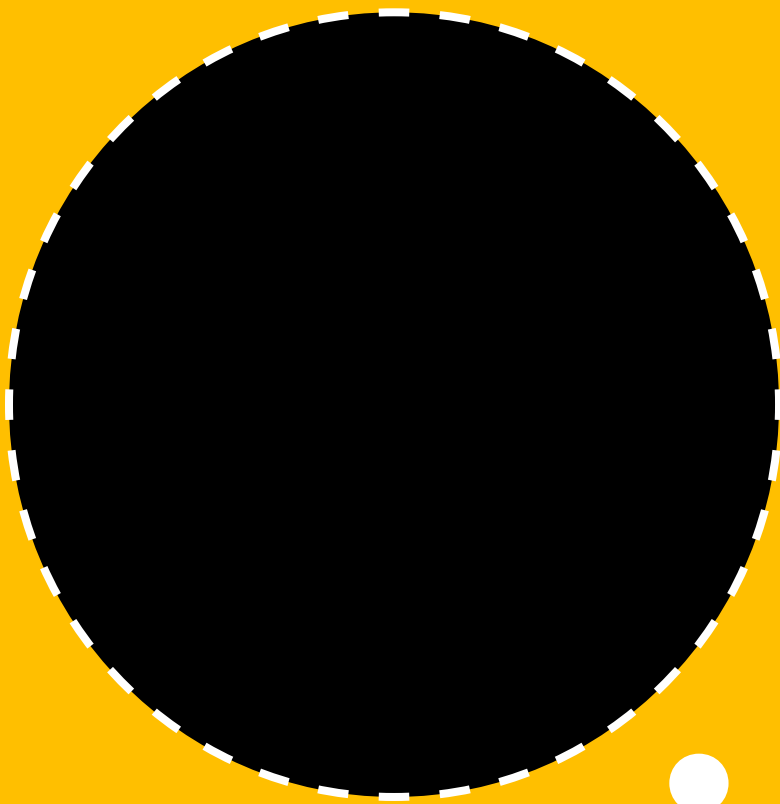
ARED

HIV/STI Testing

Every First Friday, in partnership with
Seattle LGBTQ+ Center

STEAM
WORKS bath

DIY glory hole!
Cut out for fun with a
friend, partner, stranger,
or fellow reader.



N

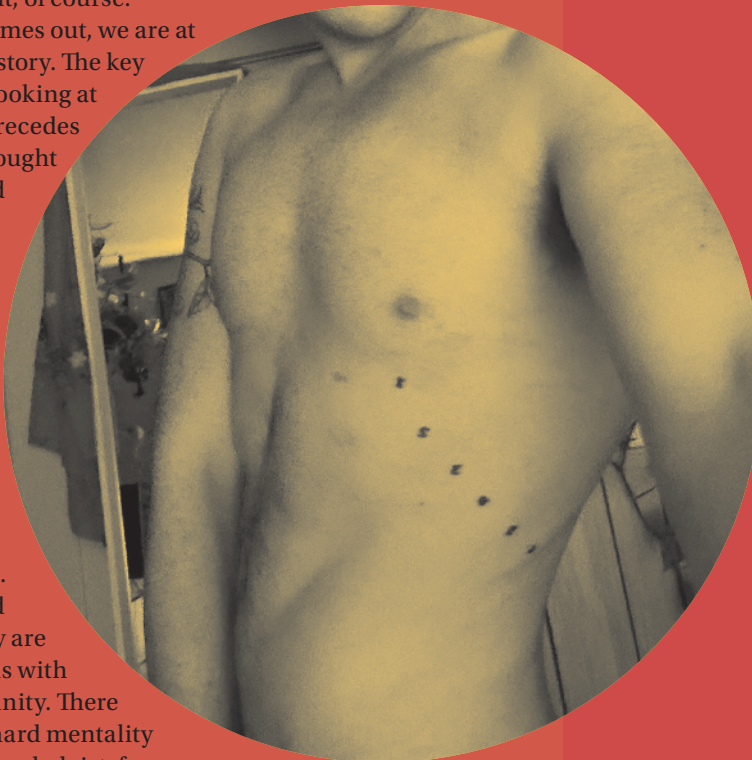
ote for your thots,

We have curated a lot of love into this edition of *Thot Bubbles* and we are very glad to share it with you. Love for community, love for queer history, love of collaboration, and hopefully you feel the love for you, our reader. By picking up this magazine, you are our community, you are invited to revel in our history and make your own part in it, to collaborate with us in this way. We truly love you for it, of course.

As this issue comes out, we are at a scary time in history. The key to surviving it is looking at the history that precedes us. Queers have fought with flare, partied through the most distressing times, and innovated revolution over and over in the cheekiest, boldest, and most shimmering, ferocious ways.

This document will carry tension. The historical and the contemporary are sometimes at odds with the queer community. There is a live-fast-die-hard mentality not dissimilar from dadaist, free spirited irreverence. At the same time, history is sacred to us. We are a heritage without lineage, born to discover ourselves and each other. Oral is the vehicle for our history, practices, pleasures, and resistance to the larger current of mainstream history that tries—futilely—to erase us. The tension of this magazine is one of joy and grief, frivolity and depth, love for self and altruism for community.

I hope that you embrace it all and that it gives you thots.
With Love,
N. Swenson



D

ear reader,

A thot bubble is the cum that pops out your ass on the walk home from your dickpointment. It's also one of those cartoon thought bubbles that pop up over your head, floating somewhere between a joke and the truth, where the ridiculous and the profound live together. That's what we're going for here: a mixture of church bells and bar bills, high heels and holy

water. Consider this ma(gay)zine the friend you bump into on your walk home at night, the one who finds beauty in the glitter and the grit.

Welcome to *Thot Bubbles 2*, the second edition of our multi-genre LGBTQ+ magazine celebrating and documenting Seattle's vibrant queer community.

Everything here is DIY and local. You're holding one of 125 copies.

On a personal note, I am perhaps most thrilled to share "The Prom You Never Went To," featuring Lavender Valley High School, home of the Fighting Poodles.

My boyfriend Michael introduced me to this story when he came home one Sunday night during Seattle Pride, vibrating with excitement. "I met the most incredible guy at the Eagle," he said. "You'll never guess the kinds of events he used to put on." That guy was Randy Henson, co-creator of an extraordinary act of queer imagination. For fourteen years, Seattle's gay community conjured an entire high school universe—complete with its own mythology, mascot, and milestones. I sat down with Randy to learn how he turned what many people never had into something they could call entirely their own.

D. Smith



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LAST FIRST DATE

**DONATELLO
DREAKFORD**

We met at my favorite theater.

The one with shaky seats
and screen burned walls,
where I always sit alone
in the same row,
in the same seat,
my church made from flickering light.

I had never let anyone into that sanctuary,
but there she was.

Just a little taller than I imagined,
stepping through the entrance
like she'd always belonged
in my quiet world.

When our eyes met,
my breath caught
like the hush in a theater
before the first note breaks the dark.

She looked at me
with warmth,
and I searched her face
for something wrong.

**“When our
eyes met,
my breath
caught like
the hush
in a theater
before the first
note breaks
the dark.”**

Some flicker of disinterest,
some subtle wince
anything to prove
that I had read this all wrong.

But there was nothing,
only softness.

Only the terrifying miracle
of being wanted
exactly as I am.

We arrived late,
missed the first few minutes.
I lied and said
she hadn't missed much
just to keep her close,
to buy time
to explain everything
she'd ever want to know.

I was grateful for the darkness.
Grateful that the screen
lit her cheekbones
and not my trembling hands.

Even someone like me,
dense,
hesitant,
accustomed to missed signals
could feel her enthusiasm
in the way she leaned in.

The way her body
answered mine.

Her arm slowly curled around mine.
Her head found my shoulder.
I kept my face forward
like I wasn't unraveling
at every gentle touch.

It took me three quarters
of the movie
to take her hand.
Once I did,
I had to count my breaths
just to remember
how to stay alive.

Eight hundred and fifty-six.

That's how many more it took
for the credits to roll,
for her to let go,
and for the world to restart.

I didn't let go
until the usher asked us to leave.

And when I did
the cold of her absence
hit me like a truth
I had no name for.

She asked to keep the night going.

I said yes
of course, yes.

We walked arm-in-arm to her car
and my stomach churned
thinking of my messy room,
a space too real
for someone this incandescent.

*(It wasn't clean.
She said it was fine,
I chose to believe her.)*

We sat on my floor
cross-legged
playing my favorite icebreaker game
while the hours spun
like warm laundry.

Every question she answered
felt like a key,
a name,
a door,
and I collected them
like sacred artifacts.

If she was going to be
as pivotal to my life
as I already suspected,
then every detail mattered.

I listened
like I was studying scripture,
and I swear
she listened to me
with that same care.

As the night softened
and my nerves gave way
to something quieter,
she crawled into my lap
like a cat.

Graceful
and certain that space
was made just for her.

Then it was.

Maybe it always had been.

She showed me pictures
of her three cats,
and I held her
like a thing
too precious to scare off.

When she relaxed into me,
melted her head
against my chest,
I almost cried.

My arms have felt empty
since the moment
she left them.

At almost three in the morning
she said she had to go
but didn't want to.

Selfishly,
I wanted to keep her
right there forever.

Instead,
I made sure she was awake enough
to drive home safe.

*(I let her stay
a few extra minutes,
just long enough
to study the puff of her cheeks
as she leaned into her arms.
To memorize
every flicker
of her resting face.)*

I wrapped my jacket around her shoulders
and as I walked her to her car
she reapplied her lip gloss,
like the rest of the night:
not subtle,
not shy,
an invitation written in shimmer.

When we said goodbye
she looked at me
like she was handing me a chance.

This time
finally
I took it.

Our lips met.

A spark,
then a fire.

Not some shy brushing,
but a moment
that cracked something open.

As if my body
remembered
what it was made for.

Like all those movies
hadn't been lying after all.

It was brief
but it was real
and I knew
with a clarity
I've never had before
that I was going to fall in love.

Not maybe,
not someday,
now.

And strangely,
instead of fear
I felt light.

Even if she changes her mind.

Even if this isn't
the beginning
of forever.

Just *knowing*
this kind of love
exists,
that my heart is capable of it,
is enough
to make me hope.

Because I've been on
first dates before,
only three now.

Some lovely,
some painful,
most forgettable.

But this?

This is the first time
I've been *sure*
it won't be the last.

And I will do
whatever it takes
to make this
my last
first
date.



NOTES ON CAMP

D. Smith

**Homosexuals constitute the vanguard —
and most articulate audience of —Camp.**
—Susan Sontag

Say ‘Hey girl, haaaaay’ ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears,” a voice echoes. “Hey girl, haaaaay,” somebody yells.

At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walkabout, where I’ve stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising.

Upstream from me, yesterday’s beach party lingers in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns someone built on the water’s edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated.

The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and Knotty Pines. As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered

the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit-themed meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmied on platforms in the trees.

Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we’re camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jockstrap.

“You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day,” Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan.

“There’s hope for me after all,” Jeffrey said.

“We always have hope,” Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. “We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson’s mother-in-law.”

“That’s the rule,” Jeffrey said.

Back at the river, the guys behind me are still chatting. I turn around and look. “When you’re cute,” a young guy says, stepping out of a tent, “all you need is chapstick and money.”

“And a hot, steaming manhole,” his friend says.

**“Two eggplant inflatables curl
in the sun, half-deflated.”**

“I can hear your funeral now,” a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. “He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps.”







I am half-watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but there are some new signs, too.

Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main camp. Laminated memorial signs wreathed in yellow and peach flowers commemorate John F. Limitone and Chris Napenias. Earlier on my walk, up the road by the trailers and RVs, I saw another memorial for Adam Gretzinger. I brush off a chair and sit down. The urge to know more overtakes me. I pull out my phone and type the names in a notepad. I remember their faces from around here. There's no cell service at camp, but maybe today or tomorrow I'll talk with someone who knows them.

From my sitspot in the Sanctuary, I can hear another group of men behind me. "I've been working on shame with my therapist," a guy says.

"And your takeaway was realizing you had enough to transfer your items from Amazon Prime bags into a beach bag." The morning light filters

through the canopy and feels bucolic, like I've entered a kind of homosexual Eden. Daisies, dandelions, and lupines grow on the riverbank, not far from the eggplant floaties. My contemplations about life and death are balanced by my fellow campers' unfiltered dialogue, born of our absurd and colorful world.

I'm part of the absurdity too, of course, another voice in the chorus. Just this weekend, my friends and I weighed the pros and cons of calling female spray tan technicians "women in science." We debated which supporting actress in *Brokeback Mountain* deserves more acclaim, Michelle Williams or Anne Hathaway.

Last night I argued for an hour with a man probably ten years my senior about which song lyric more significantly impacted the American employment rate: Britney's "work, bitch" or Beyoncé modeling the virtues of quitting one's job. At one point the man paused. This wasn't an either-or, he said. We needed to consider Dolly Parton's begrudging acceptance of the 9-to-5 grind as well.

"It'll drive you crazy if you let it," I said.

Gabfests can seem surface-level, but they're a way of wading in. That conversation, for example, drifted into a discussion of the next generation of young gay men. The man said he hoped teenagers coming out these days would lead healthy lives, especially compared to those of us who postponed adolescence and later needed therapy, or spent our twenties and thirties reassuring our inner children.

"Me too," I said, "but their youth can still be insufferable."

"Just with a better work-life balance than the rest of us combined."

Spruce and fir needles flutter and land on the empty turquoise and yellow chairs around me. I grab my thermos and continue down the trail. Chatter ensues.

"My outfit depends on the strength of this one safety pin."

"She's crying for help."

"The safety pin?"

"You, silly."

During our last visit here, I overheard an older camper mention missing someone whose life was cut short by HIV/AIDS. Michael and I were gathered around a friend's campfire. The theme that night was "angels and demons."

"I've been working on shame with my therapist."

had cardboard wings at my feet, and Michael's devil tail poked out from the back of his chair. I hesitated, then scooted closer to the guy talking. He was someone I'd connected with at the Gayzebo.

He wasn't shy, and he always dressed to the theme. That night he had cardboard tubes fashioned into horns jutting from his head.

"When did you start coming here?" I asked.

"Early nineties."

I asked if he wanted anything from the bar, a folding table stacked with bottles and manned by an angel in a halo made from a paper plate and tinfoil. He said sure, a vodka soda. After picking my way through the scattered lawn chairs and waiting a few minutes, I returned with our drinks. He was poking the fire with a stick. I knew what I wanted to ask him.

What he told me that night stays with me: that he and his friends wondered if insurance companies would count HIV as a preexisting condition, if the government would use STI test results to create a registry of gays they could target, if chapped lips came before bleeding gums, or vice versa.

"Jesus," I said, for probably the tenth time.

"I remember my friends and I laughing about hate crimes possibly decreasing because straight men wouldn't want to touch the blood after punching us."

Hours later, the path to my tent felt unsteady under my feet. The hangover lasted days, both from drinking too much and from the weight of a loss I had missed but was now inheriting.

The plague years had happened while I was growing up in a small town, where AIDS afflicted other people in distant cities, not us, not yet, not where I could see.

My hangover this morning is simpler. I can find my way out of it. After coffee, I'll pop some Advil and have a mimosa while wearing a mumu.

I cut away from the river. My crew is probably getting ready for the beach by now, packing a cooler of seltzers, water, and energy drinks.

I pass a tent with a Nicki Minaj flag on it and hear a voice inside: "Do you think we have more friends we eventually hooked up with, or more



hookups who eventually became our friends?"

"You're all going to be my friends after we figure out this forest douche." A beat of silence, then laughter—at the ridiculousness of being here, gay in the woods, somehow under- and over-packed for everything. As I walk past the site and round the corner, a few guys with tote bags pass, and I'm struck by the sweetness of this Sunday: this flamboyance of highly acerbic yet wildly generous men carrying their folding chairs and flamingo floaties and dog-eared novels and Bluetooth speakers and boxes of cheap rosé, the shadows of deer ferns crossing their feet as they walk.

If we're lucky, there'll be campers here next summer, the summer after that, and many summers into the future. I'm sure the campers will be like us in some ways, and in some ways not.

"Some of them were the kind of gays who spent their high school years shablamming in the lunchroom," one might say, remembering. "And some of them were the kind of gays who looked for packets of free lube by the cash register at the underwear store."

"True," his older friend will say. "We had to prepare for survival."

"You're all going to be my friends after we figure out this forest douche."







TRO, MUMUS, & MIMOSAS

JUAN MONROY

MY interests lean towards subcultures and the sharp corners of queer spaces and states of mind. I was very surprised when I realized how fulfilling domestic life turned out to be. People intertwining over time and trial, and the ways they change a space.

I came from a chaotic environment. I coped via restlessness. I didn't expect to like setting roots, I didn't realize how much comfort means. I thought I would have to keep moving. Home is a tricky concept for us queers. I never expected it to be euphoric or affirming. But now I do. It is my mess and I love it. My dog, always staring at that house that looks like a drawing of a house.

FAMILY PORTRAIT



"FAMILY PORTRAIT" OIL ON CANVAS, 48 X 48 IN, 2025



"DEPTH SUBJ" OIL ON CANVAS, 60 X 84 IN, 2025



“DEPTH SUBS” “DEPTH SUBS” “DEPTH SUBS”

Juan Monroy's paintings focus on the intricacies of the queer experience and the relationship between intimacy and space and personal identities. His paintings serve as a document of his interest in human behavior, its interconnectivity and the correlation between those who are being seen and those who see.

In his depiction of the human form, Monroy's body of work flirts with the boundaries between traditional portraiture and modern abstraction. His subjects are figures and stand-ins but they are also shapes and forms with ever-fluctuating levels of focus and flat.

Born and raised in Bogotá, Colombia, Juan Monroy attended the Academy of Art University Painting graduate program in San Francisco, Calif. His studies and his contact with kink communities in the SF Bay Area centered his interest in queer shame, pride, and euphoria.

Monroy lives, paints, and sometimes performs in Seattle, Wash.

YOU'RE INVITED TO... THE PROM YOU NEVER WENT TO LAVENDER VALLEY HIGH SCHOOL, HOME OF THE FIGHTING POODLES



From 1983 to 1997, when many LGBTQ+ people had been denied their teenage milestones, Seattle's queer community built their own high school from scratch. This fully imagined world came complete with Principal Sister Mary Discipline patrolling the halls, The Poodleer student newspaper covering campus scandals, and a periodic table where essential elements included Maybelline and Hiheelium.

At Lavender Valley High School, home of the Fighting Poodles, lesbians could ride a Harley down a hallway and onto the stage, cabaret could unfold in the teacher's lounge, and a detention slip could get someone into the most exclusive room in school. What began as reclaiming one night evolved into a beloved Seattle institution, where over 2,300 people annually experienced something they had been denied: a world where everyone belonged.

Q&A WITH RANDY HENSON, CO-CREATOR BY D. SMITH

SMITH: Could you walk me through what the evening looked like and what kinds of emotional responses you got from attendees?

HENSON: THE PROM was a fantasy. We had the perfect venue. The building was in lower Queen Anne, and it was designed by an architect who designed high schools up and down the west coast. So this building was like a high school... but without the classrooms. It had big windows, a gymnasium, multi-purpose rooms, and an auditorium with a balcony. The building was normally used for fraternal lodge purposes, but since those were aging out, we were able to rent it out. To have a building that looked like a high school, including an elevated stage for a band and hardwood floors all around, was a dream. On the main floor, there were two big rooms, the auditorium with the main stage, and the rock n' roll room with a live rock n' roll band. Eventually we added a third hall, the multi-purpose room, and a fourth venue, the teacher's lounge.

Attendance topped out at somewhere over 2,300 guests. The first year we did THE PROM we only used the auditorium, but we expanded every year after that. We had a principal's office at the end of the hallway, basically an information desk where volunteers could check-in with our school secretary, Miss Ann Thropy.

We had a student store where people could buy merchandise. And during the last two or three years, we had a detention hall, a very small dark space, and you had to be given a detention slip by the hall monitors to go in. It wasn't open to everyone. You had to be very bad or very good. But generally the feeling was very welcoming. Every year I got phone calls from soft-spoken people, asking "Is it okay for a cross-dresser to come to this party?" And then, "Can trans people come to this party?" I always said, "Yes. Everybody's welcome at our school."

S: Who was the principal?

H: Sister Mary Discipline, of course.

S: What are some stories that have stuck with you over the years?

H: Okay, I've got stories. There was this lesbian who owned a tattoo parlor downstairs from the Wildrose. Her name was Lamar Van Dyke, and she always let me put up posters in her tattoo parlor. One year she told me, "I'm going to bring my girlfriend to this party, and we're going to show up







on my big bike.” True to form, she pulled up on her Harley, revving her engine. She was in her leather outfit, and her girlfriend was in a prom dress. And she told my friend at the door, “Randy said we’re welcome to come to the party.” At that, he opened the doors, and she rode her motorcycle through the front door and down the hallway, revving her engine the whole way. She even rode her motorcycle onto the stage, where this rock n’ roll band was performing. Poor band, it was their first year there. But they loved it.

Turns out, there was a wedding reception happening on the third floor that night, and all the motorcycle smoke wafted up there. Folks from the Hospitality Committee came down and said the people upstairs were complaining about the smell. Suffice to say, we rented out the entire building in the years after. I bring this up because I’m proud of the how THE PROM broke the barrier between gay men partying together and lesbians partying together.

But let me back up to the first PROM we had. We didn’t have everything we had in those later years. We had a popcorn machine and a contest for who would be crowned queen. This young woman showed up in a beautiful rhinestoned tiara and a dress from the ‘50s or ‘60s with lots of tulle. She was probably in her mid-twenties. I saw her in the crowd, and she seemed sort of in awe of it all. So I walked up to her and said, “You look like a prom queen. Would you like to be in the queen contest?” And she said, “Really? Me?”

We selected a queen that night by audience applause. The queens walked the runway. The questioner asked, “What is your inspiration for being here?” And she said, “I want to thank my parents. My parents are the reason I’m here. My parents left me. They abandoned me in Seattle, and that’s why I’m here now.” She found out about THE PROM because she worked at Goodwill and had seen all these men coming in and buying prom dresses. After she asked them about it, she decided she wanted to go.

S: What first inspired you to create this?

H: What inspired me from the very beginning was being a gay political activist. I grew up in a Mormon town... so we started with something called “The Mormon Temple Tour.” Back in Bellevue in November of 1980, the year Reagan

“ She pulled up on her Harley, revving her engine. She was in her leather outfit, and her girlfriend was in a prom dress.”

was elected, the Mormons had a grand opening of a Mormon temple. The Mormons had been instrumental in blocking the Equal Rights Amendment from being ratified into the Constitution. So as a response, my friends from the University of Washington and I thought, “Let’s go have some fun with this.”

So, during the temple open house, we went thriftstore shopping for tacky tourist outfits, and we went out there and stood in a two-city block line. We looked around and thought, “We fit right in.” We were there to make a spectacle but not to be disruptive. The theme for our little tour was, “The higher you get, the closer you are to heaven.” But honestly, we didn’t make a scene, and we were treated very respectfully. I sometimes asked very pointed questions that the tour guide deflected—because he had been trained not to answer them.

But we made it to the celestial room at the top of the temple, questions and all. Afterward, we went to watch the Bette Midler concert film called *The Divine Miss M*, which was playing nearby.





We thought of it as going from the sanctimonious to the “divine.” It was that spirit of subverting typical expectations in a whimsical way that we brought to THE PROM.

Ann McCaffray was part of the original group. She grew up a good Catholic girl, and went to Holy Names Academy. Holy Names was an all-girls school... which meant she never got a normal prom. “I didn’t go to my prom,” she told me. “A lot of other people didn’t go, either. Gay people didn’t get to go...” So we printed up a bunch of flyers and went to a lesbian music concert on campus at UW. We passed them out during intermission and afterward. And I kept hearing, “Oh my god, I never went to my prom. Oh my god...” And that’s where the tagline came from.

S: Can you tell me about the planning that happened behind the scenes?

H: THE PROM was always in May, before Pride. The first year we started a few weeks in advance. We got the hall and threw it together in a hurry.

But over the years, as it got bigger, we would usually start planning around Valentine’s Day or President’s Day. We’d pick a theme, develop poster art and other promotional art, and get into sub-committees. Hospitality was in charge of greeting and taking tickets. Logistics was in charge of putting up the chain-link fence around the parking lot and moving in the stage sets. There was also Decorations, Production, Security, and more.

Then we sent out invitations and selected beneficiaries for whatever profits we made after expenses were covered. The beneficiaries were varied: the Emerald City Softball Association, the Freedom Day Committee, the Lesbian Resource Center, the Seattle Counseling Service for Sexual Minorities... We had a mailing list of over 6,000 people, and we usually had four event planning meetings, each two weeks apart.

S: How did the AIDS/HIV crisis impact the way you approached this event and other community gatherings and celebrations?

H: It was not by accident that we started doing these events. I knew some of the first people from Seattle who had AIDS.

THE PROM was not always an escape from HIV and AIDS. Many of us knew people who died, and we always had at least one AIDS organization as a beneficiary. We did our best to celebrate life while knowing what was happening and what was going on. We built community. We bonded as a community, and this helped us get through. Everyone needed another reason to live, another reason to keep going.

S: Finally, what advice would you give to LGBTQ+ people organizing community events today?

H: Use your imagination, and put it to a good use.

“We built community. We bonded as a community, and this helped us get through.”







1983

The first poster depicts a page from the newly-imagined school yearbook "The Outsider" and featured names of well-recognized figures in LGBTQ+ history. (Ann McCaffray, Randy Henson, and Ricky Rankin concept and collaboration; Ron Bills graphic design)

PROM



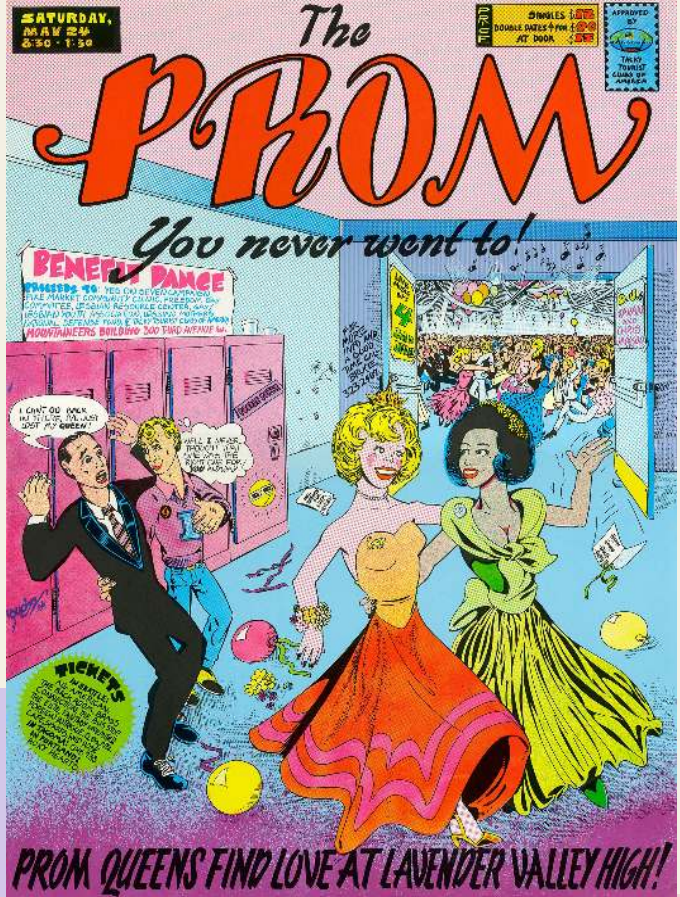
1984

The second poster features a photo taken in front of LVHS and includes Principal Sister Mary Discipline (Ricky Rankin, center) and members of the Car Club. Arden Sullivan, the first PROM queen, is shown in the left, small photo. (Don Wallen and Rob Evans photography; Brian Barilleaux graphic design; Jim LaBonte typesetting; classic cars provided by Steve Sorgee of Premiere Motor)

1986

Following a one-year break, THE PROM returned with a comic book cover-styled poster that integrated event information into its design. Notably progressive for 1986, it featured a bi-racial lesbian couple and drew attention in political circles when King County Council member Ron Sims (later County Executive) showcased it at a council meeting. (Vaughn Frick artwork)

POSTERS



1987

In recognition of the popularity of THE PROM in the lesbian community, organizers produced twin posters for the event, a male couple in one poster and a female couple in the other. (Randy Henson concept; Ernest Vigil and Lee Ratcliffe photography; Ron Bills graphic design; Jim LaBonte typography)



1988

This poster is a felt pennant in two colors, and the artwork introduced the Lavender Valley High School Fighting Poodles logo. Two hundred of each pennant (one on white felt, another on purple) were printed. (Randy Henson, Larry Lefler, and Jon Peterson concept; Jeff Fisher graphic art)



1989

A gay interpretation of the Pee-Chee folder, a popular student supply at the time. One graphic on the Pee-Chee lists eyelashes: 1) Natural Flutters, 2) Super Nova Flares, 3) Tammy Faye Bats, 4) Demi Sunbursts, 5) Standard Sleaze, 6) Ultra Alluring, 7) Cheap Drag, 8) Orthopedic. Another graphic lists important rings: Class, Friendship, Engagement, Wedding, Mood, Cocktail, Napkin, Ear, Telephone, Piston, Cock, Bathtub, Around the Collar, Faerie, Des Nibelungen, and Nipple. (Mike Mehrer concept; Marc Olson art; mischievous suggestions contributed by LVHS students and staff)



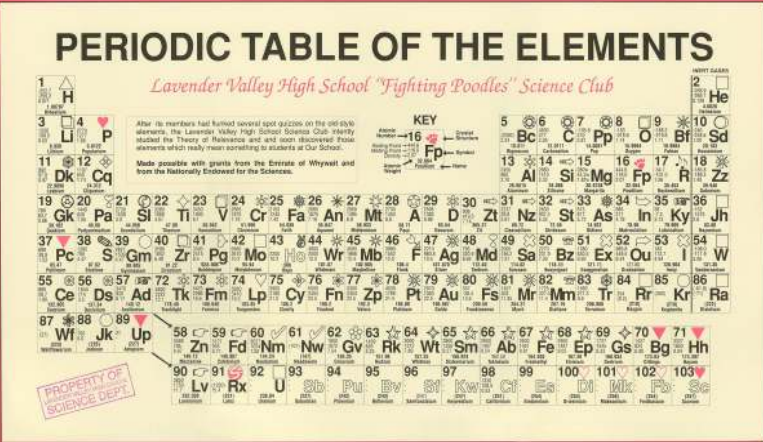
1990

This design recreates a real night in 1989 when “The Chordettes” broke down in South Lake Union en route to THE PROM. A fellow student rescued them, delivering the group to the school’s front door in his Rolls-Royce limousine. The scene features LVHS’s notorious “bad girl” Pill Munroe lending a hand. (Randy Henson and Bill Fitzpatrick concept; Geoff Manasse photography; Marc Olson design)



1991

This poster introduced THE PROM's signature "club concept." After noticing groups like the Auto Shop Boys, Book Club, and Swim Team naturally forming at events, organizers embraced it and asked The Science Club to produce a periodic table for the poster. Elements on the periodic table include H (Hiheelium), P (Popularium), Sl (Scandalium), A (Aquanet), Wr (Whiterain), Mb (Maybelline), Md (Tantrum), Si (Silicone), Ex (Exaggeration), Sa (Sarcasm), Ky (Lubricatium), Sm (Sistermarium), and more. (Scott Gray concept; Robin Evans artwork and typography)



THE PROM

...You Never Went To!

Saturday, April 27, 1991 • 8:30 pm to 1:30 am • **Mountaineers Building** • 300 Third Avenue West off Elliott

1992

With a presidential election underway, THE PROM poster embraced political satire. Designed as “The Poodleer” (LVHS’s student newspaper), it used humor to skewer petty politics and high school power struggles. (Randy Henson concept; Robin Evans graphic design, story content, and typography)



1993

THE PROM’s tenth anniversary called for a retrospective poster featuring photos from past events. The Roman numeral X design marked the milestone and referenced Spike Lee’s recent *Malcolm X* film. The poster also acknowledged Brother to Brother, an AIDS support group for Black men, as an event beneficiary. (Jon Peterson concept; Pat the Cat graphic art)



1994

THE PROM returned to the “LVHS club” concept with the Auto Club taking over. This remains the only poster in the series with a dedication—honoring charter member Darren Gere. (Gary Sweda concept; graphic art by Ashton-Breiten Design; photography by Eye Got You)

The PROM
...YOU NEVER WENT TO!

A benefit for:
Sharon's Lesbian & Gay Service
Sharon's Lesbian & Gay Service
Sharon's Lesbian & Gay Service
Sharon's Lesbian & Gay Service
Sharon's Lesbian & Gay Service
Sharon's Lesbian & Gay Service
Sharon's Lesbian & Gay Service
Sharon's Lesbian & Gay Service
Sharon's Lesbian & Gay Service
Sharon's Lesbian & Gay Service

Lavender Valley High School Auto Club

April

						1	2
3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
10	11	12	13	14	15	16	
17	18	19	20	21	22	23	
24	25	26	27	28	29	30	

Snap-on
AUTO SUPPLIES

For more info, phone Bruce at (206) 233-8842

1995

The LVHS club concept took a rebellious turn with the Detention Hall Honor Society. True to character, this poster was photographed in a Pioneer Square after-hours nightclub, showcasing the infamous Vice Sisters (Dee and Sharon, on the left). (Randy Henson concept; Colby Katz photography; Robin Evans graphic design)

The PROM
...YOU NEVER WENT TO!

Saturday, May 13, 1995

Presented by
The Lavender Valley High Prom Committee and The Detention Hall Honor Society

**They don't do it in the house
They don't do it in the house
They don't do it in the house
They don't do it in the house
They don't do it in the house
They don't do it in the house
They don't do it in the house
They don't do it in the house
They don't do it in the house
They don't do it in the house**

**300 3rd Ave West
Seattle**

For information, call Bruce at (206) 233-8842

1996

The Pep Club took charge as event managers, represented by The Cheerleaders: Bessie, Selma, and Millie. (Ernest Vigil and Lee Ratcliffe photography; Robert Henry Fein graphic design; Mike Farris, Peter Ruplinger, and Dug Wehage special acknowledgement)



1997

The final PROM called for a somber approach. This poster used a prom corsage as a funeral spray overlaying a collage of photographs that chronicled the event's 14-year history. (Randy Henson and Robin Evans concept; Robin Evans graphic art and photography)





dosomethingalready.org

DO SOMETHING ALREADY

Putting words into action for the LGBTQ+ community
to donate text "DSAGIVES" to 53-555





PONY

A VERY QUEER BAR

RESERVE - FAG POWER - DOXX YOUR EX - Be Gay Do Crime - Kill Cops & Be Gay - WHEREVER U GO THERE U ARE - Fuk - Trans allies support group - Hi Everyone - muah - A young fag from Richmond, CA was here. Thanks Seattle. - Poopoo - uwu - my wolf ears - GIRLCUM- MANCUNT - Crinkle Govner 4 ever - messy raccoon! - AVE + PIE 4EVR - hewo - Sequins & Blow - FAGS HATE GOD - FEMBOI FUCK BOI - shake it up!! - I <3 T DICK - SEPIA - 505 - GRAPHI - FAGS BASH BACK - LIVE FOREVER PRE ORDER- PENIS 2 Today - READING IS CORE - Wizard Puppies - IMAGE FAIL - CRINKLE CORNER FOREVER 2022 - BOBBY + COLLIN 4 EVER - KIRA FUCK - Dear Single-Issue Voters, GROW UP! KH 24 - Give Trans Women EVERYTHING! - FRUITY LOOPS - BUDS! - RED ALERT: COCK IMMINENT - I <3 DYKES - Boy Toy Cum Dump Was Here - Toxic Old Man Yoai forever - WOOF! - I'm Scuted - 9/11 WHO CARES? - Puppy Pussy - SARAH NELSON HAS TO GO! - wag your tails girls - LOVE MY FAT GAY - BITCH - DOG WIFE! - lesbians go! - this wall oozes cum! - yummy - FOXI BOXI - T BOYS - WEAR A MASK, SUCK DICK, KILL COPS - EVERYTHING - WANT MY BROGURT BRO? - GAY - GUTS - SAGE - GAY FUCKING - BARK!! BARK!! - this machine surrounds hate & forces it to surrender - tired_ hooker - Moth + Dog - Go Ham! - D.U.M.B - Devyn <3 - QUEERS BASH BACK - @_Josiahtubbs - DICK IN PANTIES - everyone's accusing me - YOU THINK YOU - Not Over Her and PROUD - SUPREMACY - KIKI <3 - Don't Stop Pissing - Rave Music - GO PISS GIRL - Disgust is Desire - BUSSY SAVES - mdma - Rocks - CNSR - IT'S THE __ FOR ME - Trans Kaos Clique - Generations Long - Brad <3 Cock - auston <3 - Bug Boy - CHAOS MAYHEM - I love cum - SNooping as usual I see - Demure... Mindful... Cutesy - T4T FEVER DREAM - Upzone Seattle - Lesbians <3 You - Jessa Hole - CHROMA - WORIE - CALI Boy ROY - Paint the town white! - CHCKEy - t boys are tea! - penis

Pony Graffiti Vol 1. - This is an incomplete transcription of the writing scribbled on the walls of Pony's patio. This list is about half of the full tome, primarily along the west wall. Capitalization and punctuation is preserved, but all text has been brought to the same scale, where in reality the text may have been a small secret, penned into a crevice, or a tag blasted across half the wall. The contents are political, sexual, controversial, irreverent, playful, prayerful, joyful, and pleading. As you read it, this transcription is likely already inaccurate. There are likely initials surrounded by little felt-tipped hearts, declarations made illegible by someone else's writing, the last faded part of some word made unknown. I love this collective queer consciousness, this open diary, this collection of thots that has kept me company on many nights. I hope you find a favorite.

weed - \$7.00 WEED - t4t - Lick it real good - I have an averaged sized dick that photographs well - Freddy & Justin - Pussy! - Foxgirl - PeePee - u/forestmoose - DO NOT CUM - PLEASE - VAS A VER - Slut - HI - ALL COPS MUST DIE - YOU ARE LOVED - YES! - KILL COPS - MAKE ME BLEAT - Plony - neat! - I want girl dick - what was here? - DYKES FUCK BETTER - PROTECT GAY RIGHTS - poop on my chest - Mi - CULO - @QUADRISTAN - Spread The Love - HORSIN AROUND - eat me like a cannibal - THE RIAN MILK IS VEGAN MOO! - IT'S SUPPOSED TO MATCH YOUR NIPPLES - JESS IS DRUNK! ;) - GO SLEEP WITH YOUR EX - FREE LUIGI - Drunk guy - A hot girl - Chris Nelson - IT'S PEAM - YOU ARE LOVED! - i have big boobs and that's pretty cool - I <3 MY Friends - I <3 Dykes - VAHIA - scary fans for life! - MEL - TELL SOMEONE YOU LOVE THEIR DICK - Trans Women Can Say Faggot - DRINK - Jordan Tayler <3 - WATER - OH WORM? - SOYLENT GREEN IS PEOPLE - SCUP - YOU MATTER! <3 <3 <3 - DRAGULA - DOLL - into the miftyverse - Holly - Penis Life - Cuck Puppy - AARON - DEATH 2 THE DICK - Rae Do This Bitch - Girl Fag - Fuck Rights - yeah - bit - t4t - JIZZ ME!! - CRACKIN' Eggs! - HI! - Pawns r trans - t4t CLOWN - < THAT I AM - Rodo T. Mallard - BRYCE LOVES MA - EAT CUNT FUCK BITCHES - don't make me drink alone DON'T MAKE ME DRINK ALONE - CAT BUSSY - AJ is A SMELLY BITCH - Savoia was here <3 - R+F+C+B+H+M - Ryan is HOT - DONUT UNTO OTHERS - B+A - Fuck Your Dog - tRANNYSKATEGANG<3- fuck dogs ; Knot girls - I HOPE BAN MARGERA TURNS A CORNER - NO KINGS - T4T Never have I felt more loved - Deny, Defend, Depose - FREE DC - I Love Pooy Dick! - Bex.n.Helen 5.ever - Sick Ric - YOU ARE LOVED - lol ig @omar_hbs - Omar's dick is so good - Omar 2024 - MAYBE ITS DIRTY - Andrea's Dick Makes Me Sick - MINE YOUR BIZ - CUMMIES IN MY TUMMY - WOOF - meow - THE GAYEST I'VE EVER BEEN FOR MY EYES ARE STARRY AND BRIGHT I RESERVE THEM IN MY CRADLED PALMS I AM GROUNDED IN THE CONCRETE THE

DEAPTH OF THE CORAL REEF OF SHINNING GLASS PANES OF THE SKYSCRAPERS - BLEAT
THE RICH - MOSES + FELIPE - i <3 my mommy - CHANGE YOUR SEX AND YOUR WORKPLACE
- GAY FROM COAST TO COAST - PROTECT TRANS RIGHTS - ASS WOLF - L.T.C. Backshots -
DIVERGE - A+F A+F AWOOOO - Wood Woof - Bark Bark - meow - BY GROGO! - Pee before sex! -
FAGGOT! - BEAGLEZ 4 EVA - @houndtownz - GULP - @thisgirlinseattle - CHANGE YRUSS Diaper
- Pussy Party Was Here - I HAVE GOT TO FUCK THE PONYOKE MASCOT!! - AAAA FUCK
AAUUGH!!! - fuck you cunt - endless eternal - change cyrus's Diaper - DOG GIRL DAY CARE - &
HE LIKED IT BITCH - BODY COUNT ME! - Bachelorette Bitch!! - I FUCKED YOUR HUSBAND'S
ASS BUTCH! - maz26 2012 - loser - ewu - I LOVE - Boddah - Derek + MP - Mona Mour xoxo - fARTs
SHOULD BE - I LOVE ME <3 - 80085 - How could I mot? - B+B=B2 - FUCK OFF CHASERS - charlie
kirk was an inside job - art hottie - 1312 - T4T - meow - bark for mommy - DC NOT THE STATE -
WARN - KURT WAS A GIRL - IEH Boys - Dick it's whats for dinner - Yrey + Levi - DICK MONSTER
- BULGE MASTER - Teal - Kate lived - Leasbian - The Only Meat Andrew Eats - Grim Rimmer -
Heartson - SURVIVE - YOU ARE LOVED! - Lets get dicked down by daddy - FOR A GOOD TIME ...
FINGER YOURSELF - SEMEN DEMON - DATHAN - 505 - Pup Sam for life - Heal The Earth - HORNS
SO THE DEVIL WILL KNOW ME A HALO SO GOD WILL LET ME PASS AND BOOTS TO GO WHERE
I GOT DAM PLEASE! - moo moo meadows - KAMALA: T - emery - I Love You! - TAKE Y - LOVE -
loud is the chuckling of the spectral pig - I got a little wet... - in the rain - DEATH BEFORE
DETRANSITION - how can i dance in these heels? - YOU DON'T HAVE TO FORGIVE YOUR
FAMILY - WOMAN - PENIS GIRL x FEMCEL - ROSES <3 REMI - FREAK MEAT fuck me - I <3
TOMMY - KILL COPS - mommy - Pie - OH WORM - Listen to pixel grip - KILL COPS - FUCK CYBER
TRUCKS - Marcus is the sweetest <3 - find a sun on a cloudy day - IF U READ DENNIS COOPER
ILY <3 - I TAPPED MY LANDS FOR THIS? - GET FUCKED - (respectfully) - (or DISRESPECTFULLY)
- I WANT YOUR GYATT - KURT COBAIN WAS TRANS - I LOVE FAT PUSSY + BUSSY - cunt :) -
FUCK! - KILL COPS - Mx - GOT MILK? - CUNT - DICKY - I CANT BELIEVE THEY MISSED - DICKY
- MOLTISANTY - BITSY + BRETT + ASH - R + P - FIND YOUR SPARKLE - Fe Witches Unite! -
BACO - RACO - I'M DICKSTRATED - Put A Girl On - I <3 MY Fursona - IF YOU READ THIS YOU
ARE GAY - BUD - Pussy Juicy - DICKY WITH A THICKY - TRANS - FAGGOT MOM - FIGHT - We
GOTTA corner - HEARTSON was hear - S+I - Baby - Boys - I'm a dumb SLUT but At Least I'm Hot
- yas girl keep info dumping let's share that joy! - MOMCOCK - QUIET, Homosexual - FAG? FAG!
- Just LOVE LOVE - Genevieve Loves Max - PLEASE LOVE YOURSELF - GAY! - Fambily guy - I <3
FAGS - SUCK MY FAT CLIP - FUQ OFF CHASERS - DEX WAS HERE - LOVE URSELF - ALL THE
MEATS PLC RSD 2024 - What is a pirate's favorite letter??? It's not 'R' It's 'C' - Dump'em Out -
VINCE IS WHORE - I love you! - send NUDES - suck the strap - DIAPER DEERGIRL - SAM from
LONDON (BREXIT) I PUT THE MO IN BEMO! - J + L 11/27/24 - I was there <3 Freddy - #itgetswetter
- ORCAS2015 - GirlPussy - BEHEMOTH - EAT THE RICH! #TEAM EDWARD - This Fursecution -
R3K - FAGS FOR THE DEATH OF EMPIRE - Padded Pup - #INESCROW - SAVE A CATGIRL, FUCK
A PUPPYBOY - UKLAD - GETSCRATCHED & LOVEIT! - DSG - vore your friends!!! - Legalize
BibMarriage!! - ARIN HANSON OWES ME A RIMJOB - NO PENE ON Stolen - If it fits it ships -
HELLO? - UWU - Bianca wins everytime - YANK MY TAIL - HOT RAT SUMMER - FOR A GOOD
TIME CALL/TEXT - Remember to love yourself - NO - UWU OWO - <3 MAX - BRIAN - t4t - Who's
that slut? IT'S MIGS - NO ONE IS FREE UNTIL ALL ARE FREE - LUIGI, I WILL GO BUG MODE ON
YOUR fruit moment - NEW TRICK - Butch Bottoms - BRAT CHARLIE XCX - #PRetty BRiCK -
chaser? I hardly know 'er! - BUSY DOING DYKE SHIT - CRYST! - THROAT GOAT - THIS IS YOUR
ONLY LIFE FOR NOW - Aaaaa! GT BZA - much! PREGNANT Dad SUCKS - neigh - I <3 TRANS
DYKES - BE UNGOVERNABLE - t4t - Witchie - COOPER + NICOLE WERE HERE - Cuck Puppy -
friendly - don't lie wondering - FUCK trump - PEN15 - diyhrt.wiki - H.I.N.K. - FUCK CONNOR
NASH - Transgender Street - MAYOR - LUST - Pregnant Dad SUX - BUMP MOTHER - DEERGIRLS
NEED LOVE TOO! - I Steal CUPS from heee and BREAK THEM - Fuck ICE - AL EM - PONTY - fag
+ fag - KETKIT - NB4NB - t4t - Fuck str8 Rights! - CLAW CLAW CLAW - GOTH - Charlie Kirk can
gargle my trans Balls in Hell - they them - Sara Nelson is rawdogging renters - Don't Stop Pissing

INCAPTATIONS

N. Swenson

How many love letters
have been etched into trees
carved on tables
scribbled in sharpie on a piss-room wall?

Then been left there longer than the love?

Or was the brevity of two letters
penned by a heart
a symbol of fleeting euphoria—

I sound bitter.

I love love in photographs.
Hot young lovers in statement outfits
from decades ago—
are they still together?
Where are the prom goers now?
Old? Fucking? Dead? Still in love?
Still handsome.

I'm gay but I'm somehow not gay,
a raging fag but not practicing,
but somehow always practicing.

The last time I did anything intimate:
The best, worst, only
attempt I've had at a "ho summer"...
I was drunk behind a bush,
kneeling in what was probably shit
thinking about anything else.

Is that the most gay I've ever been?
The least?
Something I'll ask
at the next John Waters Q&A.

Or maybe I'll ask him
why I still check to see
if my ex reads my Instagram stories.

Where will I be when someone
looks back
at photos of me
if someone looks back at photos
of me?
Wrapped around some former cutie?

Where will my ex be?
Where will that random dick be?
Where will the person
who shit behind that bush be?
Hopefully in love.
Or peacefully sleeping with myself...

beneath all this shit.



COSTUME BY EDA BIRTHING (@EDA_BIRTHING)
PHOTO BY ERIC MAGNUSSEN (@ERICRICHARDMAGNUSSEN)

THE LOVELY LOOKS OF

This alien costume was inspired by Eda Birthing's previous work and was commissioned for hosting a Halloween party. I love gigantic drag, especially on Halloween when you've got to squeeze through lines of people waiting for drinks and walk up and down stairs not knowing where your feet are. When I do perform in this outfit, it's usually to Nina Simone's "Don't Let Me Be Misunderstood." I love trying to pick up tips with the long hotdog fingers.

BEAU DEGAS

AS DESCRIBED BY BEAU DEGAS

This dress was one of my earlier creations. It was also the first time I attempted trimming a garment with an ostrich feather boa. I remember being so proud of it even though up close there are a lot of mistakes and the trim makes it so there's zero stretch at the bust. When I made it, my intention was to create something that was versatile and pretty that I could use for multiple numbers. I still wear it today, but I've fixed the trim since then.

COSTUME BY BEAU DEGAS/ PHOTO BY JOEY HUNTER



feel like I've always been drawn to exaggerated proportions, especially if they reference things that I love, and in this case it's ice cream. One thing about oversized costumes is that you don't know how heavy they are unless you're making it yourself. This ice cream costume is on the heavier side so I haven't performed in it, but it does take a great photo. Also, because of its weight, I now know to make sure I ask for lightweight materials when working with designers.



COUTURE BY DANIEL MINDIOLA (@DANIEL_MINDIOLA)
PHOTO BY ERIC MAGNUSSEN (@ERICRICHARDMAGNUSSEN), HAIR BY IZZY ACCESS (@IZZYACCESS/DRAAG)

grew up obsessed with movies like *Working Girl* and *9 to 5*, so creating a big business number was something I've always wanted to do. It was by pure coincidence that I came across Caterina's Instagram, and after I saw her page I knew that I had to reach out to her for a big business costume. This garment is one of my favorites for sure. It celebrates that '80s business aesthetic with exaggerated shoulders, huge buttons, and accessories. I stoned the living hell out of the watch so that it is as interesting as the top. Performing in this outfit is also super fun. I created a mix that includes as many songs that say "work" as I could think of interspersed with audio snippets from office movies.



COSTUME BY CATERINA DEROUSSE (@CATERINADEROUSSE), PHOTO BY JOEY HUNTER, STYLING BY BEAU

For as long as I can remember, I've been obsessed with classic princess ball gown shapes. So when I reached out to Eda to make this costume, it was with the intention of making a ball gown fit my drag persona. I love the way Eda embellishes garments, and it's those details that felt more Beau than other costume designers. The wig of course was the other important detail to tie this look together. Edward really made the hair as whimsical as the gown. This is definitely one of my favorite looks I've ever had on.

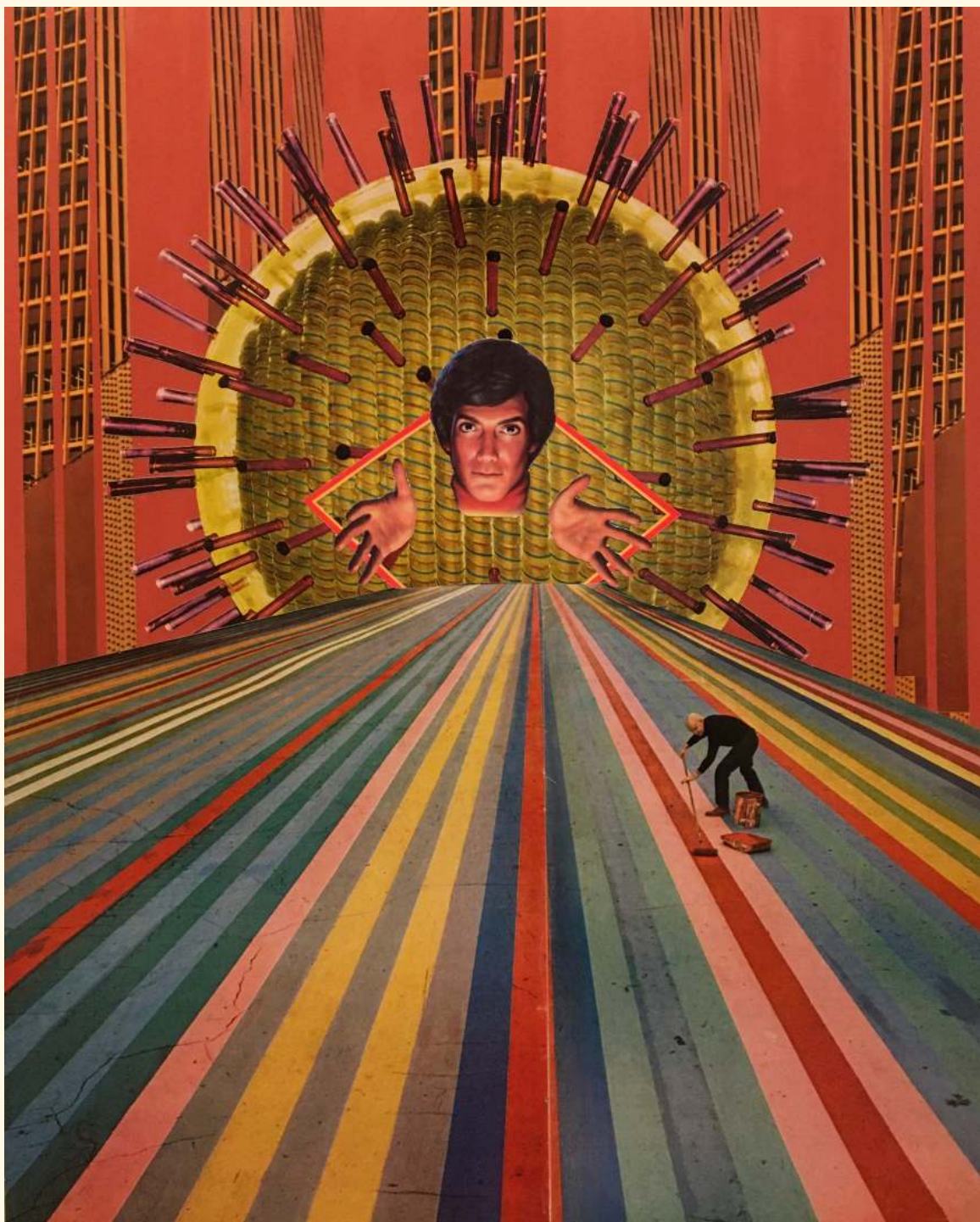


COSTUME BY EDA BIRTHING (@EDA_BIRTHING)
PHOTO BY STEPHEN ANUSON (@ITPHAN). HAIR BY EDWARD SMITH (@EDWARDJZZAHAND/2.0)

SCOTTY CAYTON

I have no recollection of what I was trying to handle on my own, but I know that I titled it this because I asked for help and I moved past it. Do it right now. Ask someone for help or tell them how you feel very directly. They'll say things you didn't expect and that is the whole reason to do it.

**YOU CAN'T
DO IT ALL
ON YOUR OWN**



"YOU CAN'T DO IT ALL ON YOUR OWN" MAGS/PAPER ON 16 X20 IN WOOD PANEL

SCOTTY CAYTON

As I write this, I have not collaged in a long time. Collage has always found me when my creativity need stillness and quiet. The last time I needed that was during Covid lockdown. I see that period as a forced reset. Everything about my life changed and everything is represented in the collages I made then.

This piece aligns with the first time someone questioned my gender. A friend had called me “him” in a social media post and another friend very kindly asked me if that felt weird. I paused because they were right. It did feel weird. I hadn’t felt like a “him” in so long. I actually had never felt that way. I just hadn’t thought about it. Whenever I tell people that this piece is how I see my gender they almost always make an awful face full of confusion. That is kind of the point.

EGGENDER



"EGGENDER" MAG/PAPER COLLAGE

SOFT SERVES WITH SHILOH DAVIES

Q&A by N. Swenson



"THAT'S A HANDFUL", SOFT SCULPTURE



"LOVE IN BLOOM", SOFT SCULPTURE

Shiloh Davies is a textile artist and costume designer. They first found inspiration as a performer in the local drag scene; but nowadays you'll usually find them behind the glittery curtain, creating avant-garde outfits and immersive installations. The majority of their work is made from secondhand materials sourced from local thrift shops. They highly recommend the curtain and tablecloth sections.

NICO: Tell me a little bit about yourself!

SHILOH: I'm a Seattle-based multi-disciplinary artist and designer looking to bring a little more play into the everyday.

N: Amazing! And what got you into sewing in creation? What's your origin story?

S: I've always been an avid thrifter. I got into sewing so that I could mend and hem secondhand garments I'd picked up. I took one basic "how to use a sewing machine" class out of a local fabric shop when I was in college, learned how to make a pillow, and then just kind of winged it from there.

I didn't really get serious with sewing until I discovered the Seattle drag scene. I was so inspired by the artistry I was seeing onstage, that I decided I wanted to start dressing the part. That then led to me sewing costumes for my own drag persona, "Sugar Darling," and eventually other members of the drag community as well.





N: What type of things do you create?

S: I would say textile art is the broadest definition of what I create. I work in soft sculpture, costuming, and installations.

N: Could you describe some favorite projects?

S: I think one of my favorite projects was my Breakfast Nook installation at the Museum of Museums. It was part of an all-textile-art show. I was given free reign to fill a room with whatever I liked. Naturally, I chose to fill it with plush plates of breakfast food. I had a lot of fun making this install and it seemed to bring people a lot of joy.

My Soft Serves costuming project was also a lot of fun. I created a collection of wearable art pieces—each one inspired by a local drag performer—out of unconventional materials like gymboree parachutes and sleeping bags.

N: Parachutes and sleeping bags? Where/how do you source your materials?

S: I source all of my fabrics secondhand, mostly from thrift stores. Most thrift stores will have a “materials” section of raw fabric. I also often grab things like blankets, tablecloths, and curtains.

I thrift pretty often and try to keep future projects in mind whenever I do so that I can start collecting materials in advance. But, because I’m kind of beholden to what I can find, projects often are shaped by what the thrift gods give me.

N: Could you tell me more about your sustainability practices and your thoughts on the fast fashion era we live in?

S: Living in America, we have a very unrealistic view of the cost of goods. We often don’t have to contend with the consequences of our cheap and easy consumption. Learning to sew made me realize the incredible amount of work and energy that has to go into every garment we buy—and how fast fashion prices cannot possibly cover that cost. Shopping secondhand—both in my art practice and in my everyday life—is probably my best sustainability practice. I am definitely not immune to the call of consumerism (I love stuff), so I thrift to scratch that itch in at least a semi-ethical way.

N: Do you have any other inspirations? Thematically or in ways you come up with ideas in your process?

S: Most of my work is about inner child work. It’s an attempt to recapture some of the playfulness and imagination that feels so easy to summon when we’re children but becomes harder and harder to access as we age. I like to create things that feel like they’re burst out of a cartoon or maybe a really good dream.

I often feel most inspired when I’m experiencing other people’s art. The best way to get my creative thoughts flowing is to check out a drag performance or gallery show.

N: Any dream projects you’d like to try?

S: I’d love to get into set/props design for theater, or maybe an offbeat kids television program.

N: Any parting words? Anything else you’re itching to communicate about the world, your practice or just some thoughts you’d like to add?

S: If you’ve ever seen something cool and thought “I wish I could make stuff like that,” you should try! I don’t have any special skills or training, I just messed around and made a lot of mistakes to get to where I am now.

Be gay! Make art! Have fun!

**“Be gay! Make art!
Have Fun!”**



**UPPER: “CASA MODERNA” SOFT SCULPTURE
LOWER: “TAKE A SEAT” SOFT SCULPTURE
RIGHT: REPURPOSED BED LINEN, PHOTO
BY STEPHEN ANUNION, MODELED BY JUAN
MONROY (ONE)**



THE ONLY COMPLETELY CONCLUSIVE PERSONALITY PROBE

D. Smith

1. DP!!!! I love...

- a. Dolly Parton
- b. Double Penetration
- c. Domestic Partnerships
- d. Dick Pics

1. Answer _____

2. Best TV:

- a. *Girls*, beach house episode
- b. *Sex and the City*, bisexual episode
- c. *The Last of Us*, gay episode
- d. *Golden Girls*, HIV episode

2. Answer _____

3. Best Cinderella:

- a. Brandy (*Cinderella*, 1997)
- b. Hilary Duff (*A Cinderella Story*, 2004)
- c. Selena Gomez (*Another Cinderella Story*, 2008)
- d. Camila Cabello (*Cinderella*, 2021)

3. Answer _____

4. I wear my scarf...

- a. reverse draped
- b. looped and tucked
- c. braided and pretzeled
- d. like a shawl

4. Answer _____

5. My softball team:

- a. Baby Back Butches
- b. Throwt Goats
- c. Bunt Cakes
- d. Scissors in the Outfield

5. Answer _____

6. Super-sexy song lyric:

- a. Lil' Kim making a Sprite can disappear in her mouth
- b. Meshell Ndegeocello asking if she can "kiss you there"
- c. Cardi B sucking a watermelon through a straw
- d. Missy Elliott's "Ra-ta-ta-ta, ta-ta-ta-ta"

6. Answer _____

7. Formative Muppet:

- a. Gladys the Cow (*Sesame Street*)
- b. Beaker, assistant to Bunsen (*The Muppet Show*)
- c. Skeeter, Scooter's tomboy twin (*Muppet Babies*)
- d. Janice, guitar player (*The Muppet Show*)

7. Answer _____

8. Fave holiday/drug pairing:

- a. molly on Memorial Day
- b. valium on Valentine's Day
- c. ketamine on Christmas
- d. post-Pride doxycycline

8. Answer _____

9. Tasked with providing the lube:

- a. insertive partner
- b. receptive partner
- c. videographer/s
- d. venue

9. Answer _____

10. When I journal, I become...

- a. Jo March
- b. Regina George
- c. Clarissa Darling
- d. Sylvia Plath

10. Answer _____

11. Fave Julia Roberts:

- a. Tinkerbell in *Hook*
- b. Vivian in *Pretty Woman*
- c. Julianne in *My Best Friend's Wedding*
- d. Erin in *Erin Brokovich*

11. Answer _____

12. Most skilled *Drag Race* choreographer:

- a. Todrick Hall
- b. Jamal Sims
- c. Alyssa Edwards
- d. Miguel Zárate

12. Answer _____

13. Least annoying celeb sibling:

- a. Frankie Grande
- b. Ashlee Simpson
- c. Dannii Minogue
- d. Haylie Duff

13. Answer _____

14. My tagline for *Real Housewives of Seattle*:

- a. "Hot enough to melt the Seattle freeze."
- b. "I make these other bitches evergreen with envy."
- c. "Watch your back, I'm always sleepless in Seattle."
- d. "This blonde roast doesn't pull any shots."

14. Answer _____

15. Most relatable celeb alter ego:

- a. Beyoncé's Sasha Fierce
- b. Lady Gaga's Jo Calderone
- c. Janelle Monáe's Cindi Mayweather
- d. David Bowie's Ziggy Stardust

15. Answer _____

16. Once while watching porn, I saw...

- a. a Beats by Dre pill on the floor
- b. a dual-dial air fryer on the kitchen counter
- c. a deck of Magic the Gathering cards
- d. an RBG biography

16. Answer _____

COUNT YOUR TOTALS:

MOSTLY A's

You're a rare gem—your friends think of you as a spiritual first responder, and they're right. Musically, you prefer "I'm A Survivor" by Reba McEntire to "Survivor" by Destiny's Child. Socially, you can be dynamic—a Blanche in the company of straight acquaintances and a Dorothy among gays. Deep down, you feel like Meghan Markle, the Duchess of Sussex, suffering through the early years of public life with Prince Harry. Your dream pet is Mantacore, the white tiger who attacked Roy Horn of Siegfried & Roy during a Las Vegas magic show in 2003. Your favorite Cazwell music video is "Rice & Beans." As you move forward, remember the disparity between how you perceive yourself and how others perceive you barely exists.

MOSTLY C's

You're a magnificent mortal—expressing yourself as freely as Lafayette on *True Blood*. Musically, you prefer "Motivation" by Normani to "Motivation" by Kelly Rowland. From a generational perspective, you possess the resilience of the Greatest Generation and the ingenuity of Gen Alpha. In your heart, you are Billy Porter entering the 2019 Met Gala wearing a bejeweled catsuit and ten-foot wings, reclining on a velvet couch carried by six shirtless men. Inexplicably, your favorite Cazwell music video is "Ice Cream Truck." Your dream pet is a black and white Boston Terrier. The best advice now is to remember that self-knowledge is also your path to being there for others, exactly as they need you.

of A's: _____

of B's: _____

of C's: _____

of D's: _____

MOSTLY B's

You're a trouble-making dyke who always said corporate pride would fail to meet the political action needs of the community—and you were right. This wisdom brings a calming influence to your social circles. Musically, you prefer "Come On Over" by Shania Twain to "Come on Over Baby (All I Want Is You)" by Christina Aguilera. You share personality traits with celebrities like Rosa Diaz from *Brooklyn Nine-Nine* and Ally Brooke from Fifth Harmony. You have the resourcefulness of Kimberly, the white Power Ranger, and the intelligence of Billy, the blue one. Your dream pet is Rocco, the tuxedo cat of Auli'i Cravalho, the American actress who voiced Moana. Your inner diva lights up rooms and radiates queer chaos.

MOSTLY D's

You silly faggot—sorry: "vivacious mixture of whimsy and vulnerability." Your dream pet is Choupette, the blue-cream tortie Birman cat of late German fashion designer Karl Lagerfel. Musically, you prefer Nicki Minaj's "Pound the Alarm" to "Ring the Alarm" by Beyoncé. You openly approve of the universally-maligned short-lived reality TV show *Real Friends of West Hollywood*, yet your thoughts about Caitlyn Jenner's politics remain private but valid. As time passes, remember the gap between how you see yourself on good days versus on bad days shrinks with every Nasty Pig purchase. The perfect mesh tank top embroidered with a snout logo is out there. Keep shopping.



THE SECOND GAY PRAYER

D. Smith

May we recover from the first.

May the scars from this one be no worse.

May this handful of vitamins jumpstart our plans.

May we bring enough bedsheets for the picnic to expand.

May our stone-butth lover play some Sapphic high-femme grooves.

May the volleyball players doing a fundraiser work their Spandex suits.

May our queeridescenct swagger elevate the vibes around the pool.

May we proclaim that TKO stands for “Tina Knowles Original.”

May we hydrate these thirsts like daisies in a Mason jar.

May we become the hoes we want to be / like to say we are.

May we get the details for whatever ABC party we’re looking for.

May we tip well when Aqua Dom and Sub Marine perform.

May the bathrooms have short lines and open stalls.

May muscle-sexuals flaunt standard-issue balls.

May they hit up archival dicks for one more round.

May the long walk home coax a few thot bubbles out.

May we curl up under our soft Weighty Gaga on the couch.

May the spicy chicken sandwich from Burger King be sublime.

May we look out the window and see prayers in the sky.

May we hear echoes of regret from other times.

And reach for gifts as they dip close by.